UNIVERSITY SCHOOL OF MANAGEMENT AND ENTREPRENEURSHIP
DELHI TECHNOLOGICAL UNIVERSITY

CONSPECTUS



THE RISE OF CROSS-BORDER E-COMMERCE : UNLOCKING INDIA'S MSME EXPORT POTENTIAL

ANUSHKA GOEL
+91 95019 55676

BHARGAVI SHARMA
+91 93129 11375

INSTRUCTIONS

1. The deadline for the submission of the solution for the case is **11:59 P.M., [27.10.2026]**. Any submissions thereafter will not be entertained.

2. The solution for the case study needs to be submitted in a single PDF. There is a slide limit of **3 slides** excluding cover page and appendix slides.

3. To submit your case solutions, please upload them in a **single PDF** file through unstop. Kindly do not upload your submissions on any other platform, as they will not be accepted.

4. Nomenclature:
The document should be named as follows - *TeamName*.

5. Use of frameworks and matrices is allowed.

6. Assumptions, if any, should be clearly stated and justified.

7. The Final Presentation Round, will be held offline at DTU East Campus (USME), Vivek Vihar, Phase- 2.

EVALUATION CRITERIA

The case submission will be judged on the following:

- Creativity
- Originality
- Feasibility
- Granularity
- Key challenges addressed

CASE PROBLEM

I. Background: The Online Export Opportunity

Cross border e-commerce lets small sellers reach global buyers without foreign offices or distributors. In 2026, India has made **e-commerce exports** a policy priority.

India is well placed to benefit. It is home to **millions of Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises (MSMEs)**, artisans, weavers, and home-based producers. They make handicrafts, textiles, jewellery, leather goods, and home décor that are in demand abroad. These producers are spread across clusters such as Jaipur, Moradabad, Varanasi and many are run by women and first-generation entrepreneurs. Together they form the backbone of India's local economies and the largest untapped pool of potential online exporters

II. Existing Problems: A System Not Built for Small Parcels

Despite this potential, only a small share of India's small producers sell abroad online. The main barrier is a **complicated export process**. A first-time exporter must deal with registrations, invoices, shipping bills, customs declarations, and tax paperwork, often across several offices and portals. Rules differ by shipping route (courier, postal, or cargo), and many of the forms are still filled in by hand or through agents. For a seller exporting a handful of parcels a month, this effort is often not worth the reward.

The problems continue after the parcel leaves the warehouse. **Customs delays** mean that small consignments can sit for days, hurting delivery times and customer ratings. **Shipping costs** are high for small parcels, because small sellers cannot negotiate bulk rates with logistics companies. **Returns** are the biggest hidden cost: a returned item is often treated as a fresh import, with duties, forms, and delays. Many sellers therefore absorb the loss or avoid exporting altogether.

But authorities cannot simply relax controls.

Large volumes of low value parcels raise risks of **under invoicing, misuse of export incentives and tax leakage** and cannot be inspected one by one. Destination markets are also tightening their own rules on low-value imports.

The challenge is to make exporting online **simple and affordable for small sellers without weakening customs checks or tax collection.**

Too much control keeps small sellers out; too little control opens the door to misuse.

CASE REQUIREMENTS

As a Policy Consultant for the **Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT),** develop a reform oriented strategy to be presented to the 2026 **Inter-Ministerial Committee on E-Commerce Exports**. Your objective is to **explore pathways to simplify cross border online selling** for small manufacturers and artisans without weakening customs checks or tax collection.

Your analysis and recommendations should address:

Market & Access Dynamics: Propose a plan to improve small sellers' access to and bargaining position on online platforms while reducing shipping and returns costs.

Regulatory and Process Reform: Define a simplified risk based export framework that reduces compliance effort for small sellers while protecting customs and tax integrity.

Stakeholder & Coordination Strategy: Design a consensus building idea to align small sellers, platforms, logistics providers and the multiple government agencies involved.

Pilot Driven Innovation: Conceptualize a scalable pilot with clear success measures that shows how sellers across regions and product types can adopt the new process through localized participation.